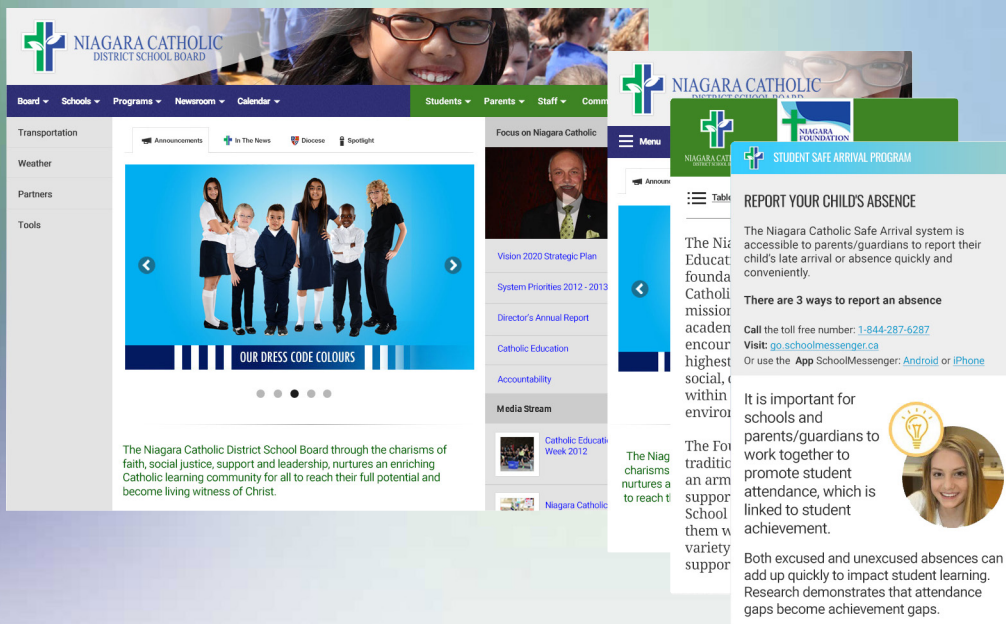


Case Study

Niagara Catholic District School Board

The Niagara Catholic District School Board is an educational institution in the Niagara Region. Funded by the Government of Ontario, currently employs over 2000 staff members and provides elementary, secondary, and adult education to over 28,000 students.



Hector Jarquin

Role

In my role as the product lead, I did oversee the end-to-end product design cycle. The large scope and limited team, allowed me to be hands-on at every step of the cycle. Each sprint was planned to be longer than the average, as each team member needed to participate at each step. As the team was given priority to work on this project, briefly attending to other responsibilities, we met a three-month projection to completion.

Overview

The objective was to bring the web presence to user-friendly and easy-to-use websites, built on a modern stack. We reached the goal with a user-centered approach design, the use of a Content Management System, training staff for publishing, REST API for content distribution, mobile-first interfaces, a front-end framework, branding, and accessibility.

Challenge

With vast amounts of content originating from different committees, departments, programs, and schools, the content was managed, published, and presented with limitations.

- **Content management:** relied on a single user tasked with content publishing on a limited publishing interface
- **Content publication:** the interface was built to display only on desktop monitors, which did not support the proper display on smaller screens and mobile devices and did not meet accessibility
- **Content presentation:** multiple audiences (staff, students, and parents) were accessing the website and it was a cumbersome process to identify, navigate, access, and interact with content



Solution

Research: we identified stakeholders (staff, students, and parents) for the process of content publishing. **Interviews:** we asked stakeholders to participate in discovery sessions to assess their needs. **Wireframing and UI Design:** after creating lo-fi and hi-fi wireframes, we designed three different UIs options for the user-facing interface. **Prototyping:** a decision was reached and we developed a working prototype to test the user's satisfaction. Content Management user administration for staff and user interface for students and parents. **Development:** after detailed review and changes, we developed according to the following points:

- **CMS:** WordPress was used as the Content Management System for authoring and publishing
- **Training:** sessions were delivered to familiarize stakeholders with WordPress
- **Documentation:** we distributed instructions and documentation to stakeholders to further aid their journey to publish on the web
- **API:** to facilitate content distribution to the different endpoints, we leverage WordPress' REST API to create stand-alone sites for easy access, navigation, and presentation
- **Mobile:** we built mobile-first layouts for every site to display content across different screen sizes and bandwidth limitations
- **Framework:** we use Bootstrap to focus development on a single front-end framework and expedite the development process and develop every subsequent site if and when needed
- **Branding:** each stand-alone site that retrieved content using the REST API displayed a unique design to properly represent their respective department, committee, and school program
- **Accessibility:** all sites were developed WCAG, AODA and WAI-ARIA compliant



User Interface Designs

STUDENT SAFE ARRIVAL PROGRAM

REPORT YOUR CHILD'S ABSENCE

The Niagara Catholic Safe Arrival system is accessible to parents/guardians to report their child's late arrival or absence quickly and conveniently.

THERE ARE 3 WAYS TO REPORT AN ABSENCE

Call the toll free number: 1-844-287-6287

Visit: go.schoolmessenger.ca

Or use the App SchoolMessenger

Download on the App Store

ANDROID APP ON Google play

It is important for schools and parents/guardians to work together to promote student attendance, which is linked to student achievement.

Both excused and unexcused absences can add up quickly to impact student learning. Research demonstrates that attendance gaps become achievement gaps.

The Niagara Catholic District School Board is committed to effective, regular and timely communication between the home and school in relation to student attendance and utilizes an electronic safe arrival system.

The use of an electronic system provides parents with an efficient method of reporting their child's absence. The real benefit of an electronic system is that parents can be notified much more quickly if their child is not at school.

More Information

It is important that there be open communication with the school especially when there are problems or concerns. Poor attendance is never the source of a problem it is a symptom that one exists. Contact the school so that attendance problems can be worked out.

More information is available at:

- Niagara Catholic District School Board Safe Arrival Policy
- FAQs
- Parent Instructions

How to use SchoolMessenger

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Senior Administration

Ted Farrell
Superintendent of Education

Ted Farrell joined Niagara Catholic in 1992 as a classroom teacher. He has served Niagara Catholic as a Vice-Principal and a Principal, and was appointed a Superintendent of Education in 2013.

Superintendent Farrell is responsible for Accommodation & Boundary Review, Alternative Programs & Community Partnerships, Continuing Education, International Education, Poverty Reduction

Board

John Crocco
Director of Education and Secretary Treasurer

Yolanda Baldasaro
Superintendent of Education

Ted Farrell
Superintendent of Education

Lee Ann Forsyth-Sells
Superintendent of Education

Frank Iannantuono
Superintendent of Education

Ted Farrell
Superintendent of Education

Ted Farrell joined Niagara Catholic in 1992 as a classroom teacher. He has served Niagara Catholic as a Vice-Principal and a Principal, and was appointed a Superintendent of Education in 2013.

Superintendent Farrell is responsible for Accommodation & Boundary Review, Alternative Programs & Community Partnerships, Continuing Education, International Education, Poverty Reduction and our eight Catholic secondary schools.

ALEXANDER KUSKA Catholic Elementary School

Home Newsletter Calendar News/Events Handbook Catholic School Council Transportation

As a community of faith, the mission of Alexander Kuska Catholic School is to work in partnership with the home and the parish to provide a Christ-centred learning environment which allows students to grow spiritually, to strive for academic excellence and to become responsible citizens with a love of learning.

Mission Statement

The school was named after our former Director and Knight of St. Gregory, Alexander Kuska. Alexander Kuska Catholic School opened in 1979 to meet the growing need in the north end of the City of Welland and consisted of 8 classrooms. Our school has since expanded to meet the needs of our community and now consists of 20 classrooms.

Alexander Kuska Catholic Elementary School is a part of the Notre Dame College School Family of Schools.

Contact Info
333 Rice Road,
Welland, ON
L3C 2V9
Ph: 905.735.4471
[Contact](#)

Grades
K - 8

French Immersion
Grade 1 - Grade 8

Principal
Carlo Arghittu

Vice-Principal
Dwane Smolders

ALEXANDER KUSKA Catholic Elementary School

Contact Menu

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-Mission Statement

NIAGARA FOUNDATION FOR CATHOLIC EDUCATION

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The Niagara Foundation for Catholic Education is a registered charitable foundation that supports the Niagara Catholic District School Board with a mission to promoting excellence in academic and religious studies and to encourage students to achieve the highest level of success in the academic, social, college and skills programs within a Catholic-centered environment.

The Foundation does not replace traditional funding for education, but is an arms-length registered charity that supports the Niagara Catholic District School Board and its students, many of them with essential needs, through a variety of programs and services not supported by government funding.

NIAGARA FOUNDATION FOR CATHOLIC EDUCATION

Donate Contact

Who We Are

Our Mission

Some of the Needs

Supporting Our Community

There's Fun in Fundraising

Annual Favourites

What we can Accomplish

How You Can Help

Make a Donation

Point to Ponder

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Watch the video below to See How Donations Produce Positive Results

Funded \$10,000 for wireless internet access

Niagara Foundation for Catholic Education Video March 2021

Niagara Foundation for Catholic Education A Mission of Excellence